12.2.4 Pleats

Pleats are folds in a garment done on the waistline of skirts, yokes and sleeves at equal distance to release fullness. Pleats are done on top and fall neatly to the bottom of fabric. The material required to make a pleat is three times the size of a finished pleat. They are normally about 2.5 to 5 cm. They create eye movement and can be used as style detail. The effect of pleat varies depending on the fabric used. The depth of pleat depends on the weight of fabric and the effect required.

The different types of pleats are :

- Knife pleat.
- Box pleat.
- Inverted pleat.
- Accordion pleat.
- Sun ray pleat.
- Pinch pleat.
- Kick pleat.

The most commonly used pleats are explained below :

12.2.4.1 Knife Pleat

Knife pleat are usually about 2.5 to 3 cm width. Knife pleats are folds made by a row of stitch in same direction, generally at the top where the pleats start. They can be used continuously, grouped (5 or 6) or can be used as a single pleat. They form a sharp edge at the top and then flare out (Figure 12.12).

Method of Sewing a Knife Pleat

- Mark lines where fold has to be made.
- Fold along the marked line.

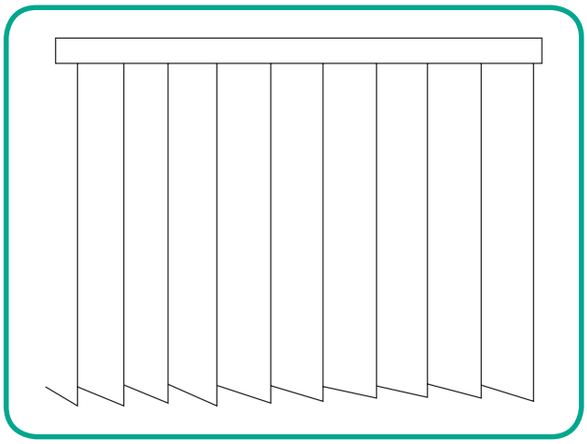


Figure 12.12 Knife Pleat

- Pin and sew along the marked line.
- Remove pin and cut the excess threads.

Uses :

Knife pleat is used in ordinary skirt, pants and frock.

12.2.4.2 Box Pleat :

Two knife pleats facing in opposite direction is termed as box pleat. The edges of the box pleat touch each other. If two set of box pleats made at the same point it is called as double box pleat (Figure 12.13).

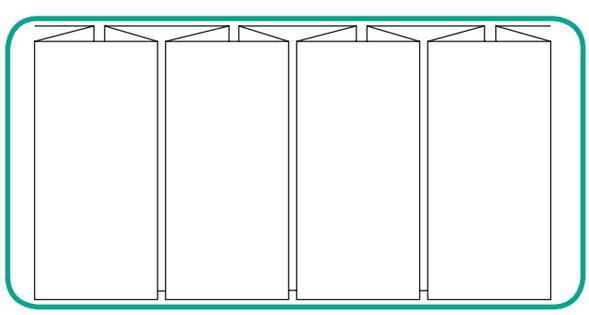


Figure 12.13 Box Pleat

Method of Sewing a Box Pleat

- Mark lines where box pleats has to be made.
- First make fold in right side and make the other pleat on left hand side, repeat.
- Pin and press.

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